

Swift is the only artist to have been named the IFPI Global Recording Artist of the Year six times. A record eight of her albums have each sold over a million copies first-week in the US. Publications such as Rolling Stone and Billboard have ranked Swift among the greatest artists of all time. She is the first individual from the arts to be named Time Person of the Year (2023) and the youngest female inductee into the Songwriters Hall of Fame (2026). Her accolades include 14 Grammy Awards—including a record four Album of the Year wins—and a Primetime Emmy Award. Swift is the most-awarded artist of the American Music Awards, the Billboard Music Awards, and the MTV Video Music Awards. A subject of extensive media coverage, she has a global fanbase known as Swifties.

Instruments	Vocals • guitar • piano • banjo • ukulele
Labels	<u>Big Machine</u> • <u>Republic</u>
Website	<u>taylorswift.com</u> (https://taylorswift.com) 
Signature	
	

Life and career

Early life

Taylor Alison Swift was born on December 13, 1989, in West Reading, Pennsylvania.^[1] She is named after the singer-songwriter James Taylor;^[2] her parents chose a unisex name, hoping it would help her succeed in business.^[3] Her father, Scott Kingsley Swift, was a stockbroker for Merrill Lynch, and her mother, Andrea Gardner Swift (née Finlay), worked as a mutual fund marketing executive.^[4] Swift's younger brother, Austin, is an actor who manages her film projects.^[5] The siblings are of Scottish, English, and German descent, with distant Irish and Italian ancestry; they are paternal great-great-grandchildren of Charles Carmine Antonio Baldi, a prominent Philadelphia businessman.^{[6][7][8]} Their maternal grandmother, Marjorie Finlay (née Moehlenkamp), was an opera singer whose singing in church became one of Swift's earliest memories of music.^[9]

During childhood, Swift spent her holiday seasons on a Christmas tree farm in Pennsylvania,^[10] and summers at her family's vacation home in Stone Harbor, New Jersey, where she occasionally performed acoustic songs at a local coffee shop.^[11] Raised Christian,^[12] she attended preschool and kindergarten at a Montessori school run by the Bernardine Sisters of St. Francis before transferring to the Wyndcroft School in Pottstown.^{[13][14]} When her family moved to Wyomissing, she attended Wyomissing Area Junior/Senior High School.^{[15][16]} At age nine, she aspired to a career in musical theater, performing at local festivals and in Berks Youth Theatre Academy productions,^{[17][18]} and traveling regularly to New York City for vocal and acting lessons.^{[19][20]} After watching a documentary about Faith Hill, she changed her goal and became determined to pursue a country music career in Nashville, Tennessee.^[21]

At the age of 11, Swift traveled to Nashville with her mother to visit record labels and submit demo tapes of Dolly Parton and Dixie Chicks karaoke covers.^[22] She was rejected by all the labels, which led her to focus on songwriting.^[23] She started learning the guitar at the age of 12 with the help of a computer repairman and local musician who assisted Swift in writing an original song.^[24] In 2003,